

Conflict Resolution & Household Decisions — Interview Practice Questions

(keep answers simple, truthful, and calm).

1) General conflict style (how you handle disagreements)

- When you disagree, do you usually talk it out right away or take time to cool off first?
- Who is more likely to start the conversation to resolve things?
- Do you prefer to talk the same day or the next day?
- Do you ever use texting to resolve issues, or mostly face-to-face?
- Do you have any ground rules (no yelling, no name-calling, take breaks)?

2) Typical topics of disagreement (keep factual)

- What kinds of things do you disagree about most often (chores, money, time, family, driving)?
- Are disagreements usually small and quick, or do they sometimes take time to resolve?
- Do you usually agree on major values (family, religion, finances), or do you work through differences?

3) How you resolve and move forward

- What does resolution usually look like for you (apology, compromise, plan, schedule change)?
- Who is more likely to apologize first (if that's true)?
- Do you ever revisit the same issue later? If yes, which one and why?
- Do you talk to a friend/family member for advice, or keep it private?

4) Communication patterns during conflict

- Do you tend to talk calmly, get quiet, or get emotional during disagreements?
- Do either of you need space during conflict (go for a walk, different room)?
- How long does it typically take before you're back to normal (minutes, hours, next day)?
- Do you usually hug/make up, or just move on normally?

5) Household decisions (small, everyday choices)

- Who usually decides what's for dinner?
- Who decides household purchases (groceries, cleaning supplies, small items)?
- Who handles scheduling (appointments, repairs, errands)?
- Do you have a shared calendar or do you coordinate by texting?

6) Big decisions (moving, purchases, vacations)

- Who typically brings up big decisions first (moving, buying furniture, travel plans)?
- Do you decide together or does one person lead the planning?
- Who handles research/price comparisons (apartments, cars, flights, big purchases)?
- Who usually pays deposits or makes final bookings (if applicable)?
- Give an example of a big decision you made together recently (move, purchase, trip).

7) Money decisions and budgeting (if relevant)

- How do you decide on big spending (talk first, set a limit, separate spending)?
- Do you have a set budget or a general agreement about spending?
- Who tracks bills and due dates?

8) Influence from others (family/friends)

- Do family members influence big decisions (moving, holidays, finances)?
- How do you handle it if family opinions differ from your plans?
- Do you consult anyone before big decisions (parents, siblings, close friends)?

9) Recent disagreement (keep it simple and truthful)

- What is a recent disagreement you had (topic only, keep it simple)?
- When did it happen (roughly) and where were you (home, car, on a call)?
- How was it resolved (talked same day, apologized, made a plan, compromised)?
- Did it change anything going forward (new routine, new rule, different approach)?

10) “Reality check” questions (recent and specific)

- What was the last decision you made together this week (meal, purchase, plan)?
- What was the last big purchase you discussed and who finalized it?
- When was your last disagreement and what did you do afterward (dinner, silence, talk)?
- Who initiated the resolution conversation most recently?

Tip: Don't exaggerate or invent details. If you can't recall exact timing, say "around" and keep the story consistent between both spouses.